MONTHLY UPDATE

Uganda: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Cybersecurity

DPI
Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government

TECHNOLOGY
AI · ICT Industry · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Literacy · Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

DATA
National statistics

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Uganda Targets AI Sovereignty, Minister Says** — Nile Post, 10 September 2026

  Uganda is developing an artificial intelligence strategy aimed at building national capacity to develop, govern and benefit from the technology rather than depend on foreign systems, its science and technology minister said. He named data, computing infrastructure, energy, models, applications and skills as the foundations that need investment.

DOMESTIC TAXES COMPLIANCE RISK MANAGEMENT STRATEGY

- **URA unveils data driven tax compliance strategy for FY2026/27** — Eagle Online, 14 September 2026

  URA's FY2026/27 compliance risk strategy uses taxpayer, transaction and sector data to target evasion.

NATIONAL COMMUNICATION POLICY, 2026

- **Government Launches National Communication Policy 2026** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance (Uganda), 13 October 2026

  Common standards for MDAs and local governments; crisis communication, access to information, citizen feedback.

Legislation and regulation

UCC ORDER SUSPENDING PUBLIC INTERNET

- **Uganda Communications Commission explains internet shutdown** — New Vision, 7 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator published the text of its suspension directive: public internet, new SIM sales and outbound data roaming stopped, mobile VPNs disabled, a whitelisted exclusion list from referral hospitals to railway signalling, and restoration only on written notice.

DIGITAL LENDING PLATFORM REGULATION

- **Uganda's central bank to probe claims mobile money users are paying off strangers' loans** — Kikubolane, 15 September 2026

  BoU opens a probe as MPs allege wallet deductions from non-consenting guarantors; digital loans up 110.8%.

- **MTN, Airtel deny deducting customers' money without consent** — PML Daily, 16 September 2026

  Both operators tell COSASE their lending is unsecured and unguaranteed, and ask UCC to block unlicensed apps.

RESTRICTION OF REPEAT ONLINE OFFENDERS

- **Uganda proposes stricter measures against serial cyber offenders** — CAJ News Africa, 15 September 2026

  The communications regulator said it is working with parliament on a framework allowing targeted denial of service to repeat abusers of cyberspace, its director likening the measure to withdrawing a driving licence. No bill, offence definition or appeal route is published.

UCC ENFORCEMENT AGAINST UNLICENSED PUBLIC WI-FI

- **UCC Reviews Crackdown on Unauthorised Wi-Fi Operators After Complaints** — Nile Post, 12 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator said it is reviewing its enforcement against unauthorised Wi-Fi and hotspot resellers after complaints from operators. A public notice was promised within the week.

- **Press Release on Illegal Wi-Fi Hotspots** — Uganda Communications Commission, 13 October 2026

  About 4,000 unlicensed resellers; UGX 148bn yearly tax loss claimed; URA import block, nationwide take-down imminent.

Data protection

PROSECUTIONS FOR UNLAWFUL DISCLOSURE OF PERSONAL DATA

- **Three arrested over alleged fake news, personal data offences on social media** — Nilepost, 1 September 2026

  Kampala police hold three over July's fake-news and data offences; charges can carry up to 10 years.

- **TikToker charged over alleged fake news, data disclosure** — New Vision, 7 October 2026

  A TikTok user was charged in Kampala on 6 October with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data under Uganda's data protection act, and with publishing false news, over a photograph and video of a State House employee. He denied the charges; the case returns on 19 October.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION CAMPAIGN

- **Uganda Launches Child Online Protection Campaign to Promote Safer Internet Use** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school, to teach children to recognise and manage online risks. The ICT permanent secretary called on parents, schools, technology companies and government to share the work.

Regional collaboration

UGANDA-SOUTH SUDAN CROSS-BORDER HEALTH SECURITY MEMORANDUM

- **South Sudan, Uganda sign agreement on cross-border health security** — Radio Tamazuj, 8 September 2026

  SOUTH SUDAN

  Juba MoU sets real-time epidemiological data sharing and joint surveillance on the South Sudan-Uganda border.

CUSTOMS COOPERATION MEMORANDUM WITH THE SOUTH SUDAN REVENUE AUTHORITY

- **South Sudan, Uganda Sign MoU to Strengthen Customs Cooperation** — Juba Echo TV, 16 September 2026

  SOUTH SUDAN

  Third SSRA–URA MoU adds e-permit enforcement and customs digital interoperability; three-layer oversight.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

URA E-TAX2 AWARD

- **URA engages manufacturers on new tax reforms, digital systems and import fee changes** — Mulengera News, 11 September 2026

  eTax2 build began February 2026; TIN retired for NIN and BRN across the tax register.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SMARTPHONES IN USE

- **UCC launches study on smartphone usage as Uganda targets universal coverage by 2030** — The Independent / URN, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a study of smartphone penetration, device cost and usage, against a stated target of full national network coverage by 2030.

STARLINK OPERATIONAL LICENCE

- **Govt welcomes Starlink internet service provider** — New Vision, 2 September 2026

  Starlink began commercial service in Uganda, ending the regulatory process that followed a memorandum and a five-year operating licence signed with the communications regulator in May 2026. The licence requires a national gateway and physical point of presence, an operational office, and registration of every device activated in the country.

- **Starlink goes live in Uganda; price comparisons against MTN, Airtel** — Pulse Uganda, 2 September 2026

  Prices published with the Ugandan launch put a residential 100 Mbps package at Shs203,704 a month against an estimated Shs2.3 million to start, plus a Shs437,036 regulatory charge — against fibre offers from the two mobile incumbents advertised at Shs110,000 and Shs99,000 for the same speed.

UGANDA-TANZANIA FIBRE ROUTE ON THE TRANSMISSION NETWORK

- **UETCL in Spotlight Over Uganda-Tanzania Fibre Connection** — Nile Post, 4 September 2026

  Parliament questions UETCL's cancelled open bid for the Uganda-Tanzania fibre link amid Shs77bn arrears.

PARATUS GOMA-MOMBASA ROUTE

- **Paratus expands East Africa connectivity ahead of ITW Africa** — TechTrendsKE, 9 September 2026 DRC RWANDA KENYA

  Paratus said its 2,000km Goma-to-Mombasa terrestrial fibre route is live and carrying traffic, announced at the ITW and Datacloud Africa conference in Nairobi. The route links eastern DRC to the Kenyan coast through Kigali, Kampala and Nairobi, with access to subsea capacity landing at Mombasa. Starlink services have launched in Uganda alongside it, and the company is introducing a Layer 2 connectivity service over low-earth-orbit satellite for the East African market.

AIRTEL SATELLITE-TO-MOBILE SERVICE WITH STARLINK

- **Airtel Uganda Rolls Out Starlink Satellite-to-Mobile Service** — Tech Africa News, 24 September 2026

  Airtel Uganda launched Starlink satellite-to-mobile service, giving compatible smartphones SMS and light data such as WhatsApp outside terrestrial coverage, free for a 30-day trial and then through data bundles. Uganda is Airtel Africa's second commercial market for the service after the DRC in August.

UGANDA TELECOM REVIVAL AGREEMENT

- **Museveni Orders Cancellation of UTel Deal, Calls Investors 'Bafere' Over Missing $25 Million** — Nile Post, 9 October 2026

  State House meeting 6 Oct; RCC never paid initial $25m of $225m; 60/40 stake; Cabinet paper on state-funded revival.

Data Storage

THIRD NATIONAL DATA CENTRE IN THE NITA-U STRATEGIC PLAN

- **Blogs: Plan now for infrastructure to power AI** — New Vision, 10 October 2026

  Opinion: a 10-15-year national compute programme led by NITA-U; third data centre planned for Entebbe, recovery in Jinja.

Cybersecurity

CENTRAL BANK INTERNAL SECURITY SYSTEMS

- **Bank of Uganda strengthens security measures** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Bank of Uganda's governor told Parliament's Public Accounts Committee that the central bank has strengthened its internal security systems after a physical break-in and allegations of system manipulation at its headquarters. He said the incidents involved a physical breach and fraudulent payments rather than an external cyberattack.

FINANCIAL-SECTOR CYBER AND FRAUD INCIDENTS

- **Uganda Records 6,533 Cyber and Fraud Incidents, Losses Hit Shs24bn** — Nile Post, 23 September 2026

  The Uganda Bankers' Association counted 6,533 cyber and fraud incidents in the financial sector from January to August 2026, with UGX 24 billion lost and a further UGX 68 billion estimated at risk. At the same forum the Deputy Chief Justice said the judiciary is open to specialised handling of cyber and financial crime.

DPI

Data Exchange

REVENUE-AUTHORITY ENFORCEMENT OF A THIRD COUNTRY'S IMPORT E-PERMIT CHARGE

- **On The Spot: URA Links With US-Sanctioned South Sudan Firm Crawford Capital Raises Concern - The Capital Times** — The Capital Times, 1 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN KENYA

  URA and KRA still enforce Crawford Capital's e-Permit collections at borders after the 12 May 2026 US sanctions.

INTERNATIONALLY SHARED FINANCIAL DATA IN TAX ENFORCEMENT

- **URA tightens net on undeclared foreign income, offers window to regularise** — VividVoice, 13 September 2026

  URA matching TINs to foreign assets from shared data, with a voluntary window to mid-2027.

UGPASS

- **NITA-U moves to replace paper-based land verification with digital checks** — New Vision, 17 September 2026

  Uganda's IT authority is building a digital signature and document-authentication service on the national authentication platform, binding a signature cryptographically to the holder's national identification number so land sale agreements, transfer forms and consent letters can be signed digitally. The integration platform is to carry real-time verification to the registration authority, so a lands office checks the register rather than a photocopied card; forged signatures in land transactions are the stated first target.

UGHUB

- **News: NIRA to register learners, correct identity errors in December** — New Vision, 1 October 2026

  December LC-level drive for learners without NINs and record corrections; UGHub links NIRA to over 150 MDAs.

Digital Identity and CRVS

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER AND THE TAXPAYER NUMBER

- **What 'NIN Will Replace TIN in All Transactions' Actually Means** — Business Times Uganda, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's cabinet approved phasing out the standalone taxpayer identification number for individuals, replacing it with the national identification number already printed on the identity card. Nothing states a commencement date or a transition arrangement for the roughly nine to ten million Ugandans not yet on the register.

- **Minister Musasizi Explains Why NIN Is to Be Used as TIN as ICPAU Commits to Enforce AI Adoption in Accountancy Sector** — Mulengera News, 3 September 2026

  Finance minister: NIN does not replace the TIN; the two must be made to read each other.

- **URA Explains Use of NINs to Replace TINs** — Nilepost, 7 September 2026

  Uganda's revenue authority says the move from taxpayer numbers to national identification numbers will not automatically make every citizen a taxpayer, the purpose being a single more secure identifier for government services and more accurate taxpayer records. It follows the finance minister's statement four days earlier that the two numbers must be interoperable rather than one replacing the other.

- **Transitioning from TIN to NIN will create jobs and open up formal markets** — New Vision, 16 September 2026

Uganda's revenue authority said the taxpayer identification number will be phased out for individuals in favour of the national identification number, with companies using their registration number instead. It said the old system reached only just over 5 million taxpayers and that the change will remove duplicate and ghost records.

- **Government launches integration of National ID, tax identification systems** — NTV Uganda, 30 September 2026

  Uganda's internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems at the country's first Identity Expo and Symposium in Kampala.

- **Linking NINs to Tax Records Will Tackle Identity Theft, Says URA** — Nile Post, 30 September 2026

  Fingerprint consent at URA counters; NIRA biodata fields pulled named, marital data excluded; entity numbers via URSB.

PEOPLE ON THE NATIONAL REGISTER

- **NIRA register reaches 36.15 million people** — New Vision, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's identification authority holds 36.15 million people on the national register, close to 77% of a population the 2024 census put at 45.9 million, leaving nine to ten million unregistered. The figure matters because cabinet has just made that register the basis of tax identity.

TAX IDENTIFICATION NUMBER MERGED INTO THE NATIONAL ID NUMBER

- **ANDREW BABA: URA's TIN to NIN Migration, The Benefits and Risks of Uganda's New Tax Identity System** — Insight Post Uganda, 2 September 2026

  Analyst on folding the TIN into the NIN: fewer duplicate identities, more concentrated exposure.

- **Minister Musasizi Explains Why NIN Is to Be Used as TIN as ICPAU Commits to Enforce AI Adoption in Accountancy Sector** — Mulengera News, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **URA Explains Use of NINs to Replace TINs** — Nilepost, 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

ID CARDS PRINTED AGAINST COLLECTED

- **NIRA staffing crisis leaves millions of IDs gathering dust** — The Independent, 9 September 2026

  5.4m printed IDs uncollected; 418 of 571 posts filled, 201 client-facing; NIRA asks for 998.

NIRA STAFFING AGAINST APPROVED ESTABLISHMENT

- **NIRA staffing crisis leaves millions of IDs gathering dust** — The Independent, 9 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

NATIONAL SECURE IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **NIRA on Spot as New National IDs Fail to Work for SIM Registration, Banks and Driving Permits** — Business Focus, 11 September 2026

  New Ugandan IDs still inactive; MTN the only partner fully onboarded to NIRA's March 2026 data-exchange module.

IDENTITY-ANCHORED DIGITAL SIGNATURE FOR LAND DOCUMENTS

- **NITA-U moves to replace paper-based land verification with digital checks** — New Vision, 17 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

LOCAL PRINTING OF SECURE DOCUMENTS (UGANDA SECURITY PRINTING COMPANY)

- **Secure documents to be printed locally** — New Vision, 29 September 2026

  New factory to print ID cards, passports, permits, land titles and ballot papers; NIRA supplied security features.

SHARE OF THE POPULATION IDENTIFIED

- **Identity is the Foundation of Security, Development, Says Minister Kamuntu as NIRA Expo Opens** — Nile Post, 29 September 2026

  Figures at the opening of Uganda's first national identity expo put about 36.2 million people identified, roughly 78.8% of the population. The internal affairs minister called on the registration authority to reach everyone.

LEARNER REGISTRATION AND IDENTITY-RECORD CORRECTION EXERCISE

- **News: NIRA to register learners, correct identity errors in December** — New Vision, 1 October 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Digital Payments and Fintech

KAMPALA-ENTEBBE EXPRESSWAY TOLL COLLECTION

- **Mobile Money Toll Payments Coming to Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — ChimpReports, 11 September 2026

  Test runs done, dedicated lanes coming; platforms, fees and start date undisclosed amid Egis contract scrutiny.

- **MTN Uganda Launches Mobile Money Toll Payments on Kampala-Entebbe Expressway** — Tech Africa News, 25 September 2026

  MTN Uganda and the Ministry of Works and Transport launched Mobile Money toll payment on the Kampala-Entebbe Expressway, at the Busega, Kajjansi and Mpala plazas on designated lanes. The motorist gives a phone number to the attendant and approves a PIN prompt; no fee was named.

EACBOND REGIONAL CUSTOMS GUARANTEE

- **Afreximbank issues a $29 million guarantee to scale EAC Customs Bond, easing movement of goods across East Africa** — African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank), 22 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  US$29m guarantee to BSMART Technology for the digital EAC Customs Bond; piloted in Uganda 2025, launched March 2026.

PRIDE BANK SERVICES ON THE INTERSWITCH AGENT AND CARD NETWORK

- **Pride Bank and Interswitch join forces to deliver easier, accessible banking solutions to customers** — The Independent (Uganda), 22 September 2026

  Quickteller agency banking via 21,000+ agents; Verve cards on 650+ ATMs and 20,000+ POS points.

Registries

SUGAR INDUSTRY INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

- **Trade Ministry launches digital system to register sugarcane farmers** — New Vision, 3 September 2026

  SIIMS to register every sugarcane grower and centralise cultivation, milling and market data.

DIGITAL NUMBER PLATE SYSTEM

- **Parliament Probes Digital Plate Crisis as Delays Cost Uganda Shs4bn Weekly** — Business Times Uganda, 6 September 2026

  Daily plate output down from about 350 to 100; MPs put the cost at over Shs4bn a week, first-registration fee Shs714,300.

- **MPs grill digital plate makers over Shs4b weekly losses** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 29 September 2026

  Output down from 350 to under 100 sets a day (June 2026); Shs4bn weekly losses claimed; URA asked for figures.

- **Ministry clears digital number plate backlog amid Parliamentary scrutiny** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 30 September 2026

  Kampala bond fitment down from 19 days (Dec 2025) to 2 (Sep 2026); supply restored Aug 2026; taxes up 17% in year one.

- **MPs Verify, Confirm Digital Number Plate System is Working During Naguru Command Centre Visit** — Nile Post, 3 October 2026

  Live tracking demo for MPs; 337 of 375 stolen vehicles recovered per police; data said to be stored in Uganda.

- **Attorney General declares 2021 digital number plates contract null, illegal** — Daily Monitor, 6 October 2026

  Uganda's Attorney General told a parliamentary committee that the supplier of the digital number plate system has consistently failed the core obligations of its 2021 contract, which the newspaper reports him declaring null and illegal. Defaults cited include no training of Ugandan staff and no transfer of the system's technology to the state enterprise.

- **How ignored warnings, missing feasibility studies plagued Uganda's digital plates project** — Daily Monitor (Uganda), 13 October 2026

  A former works minister told a Ugandan parliamentary committee that the digital number plate rollout went ahead without a preliminary feasibility study, and a former internal affairs minister said early warnings were ignored. The contractor defended plate fees paid to it rather than into the Consolidated Fund.

- **MPs Order Detention of Two Auditors Over Unaudited Digital Number Plate Project** — Nile Post, 14 October 2026

  Uganda's parliamentary Physical Infrastructure Committee ordered two directors of the Office of the Auditor General detained after they said the digital number plate project (ITMS) has not been audited since it began in 2021. The Auditor General said the project was classed as security-related and is financed by the Russian firm Joint Stock Company Global Security; motorists pay over Shs750,000 a plate.

MODULAR MOTOR VEHICLE REGISTRATION COMPONENTS PROCUREMENT

- **Whistleblowers ask Museveni, IGG to halt Shs158bn digital plates deal** — Daily Star Uganda, 27 September 2026

  Claim of paying twice for ITMS registration functions and vendor lock-in; IGG, PPDA and COSASE review sought.

DIGITISATION OF THE CHIEF REGISTRAR'S ADVOCATES AND BAILIFFS RECORDS

- **Uganda: Judiciary Digitises Advocates, Bailiffs Records to Improve Access** — allAfrica, 9 October 2026

  Chief Registrar's files all scanned; searchable data capture next, first phase due end of October 2026.

LAND REGISTRY DIGITISATION

- **Government Moves to Reduce Cost of Obtaining Land Titles** — Nile Post, 11 October 2026

  Fees over Shs2.5m to surveyors cited; blockchain records, drones against overlapping titles; surveyors to be registered.

Sectoral management information systems

E-WARD ROUND REMOTE SPECIALIST PLATFORM

- **Chil Group Launches Digital Platform Linking Rural Hospitals to Urban Specialists** — Nilepost, 3 September 2026

  Virtual ward rounds for 260+ rural wards; per-bed cryptographic tokens and AI triage on live vitals.

PARISH DEVELOPMENT MODEL INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **Alarm raised as 50% of Zombo PDM tablets fail to function** — ChimpReports, 11 September 2026

  31 of 61 parish tablets dead; UGX 12.6bn revolving fund outstanding, UGX 13m recovered.

- **Uganda's Parish Development Model Reaches 3.5 Million Beneficiaries With $1.1 Billion Government Investment** — The Kampala Report, 18 September 2026

  An inter-ministerial meeting put Uganda's Parish Development Model at 3,571,108 beneficiaries against UGX 4.317 trillion capitalised through 10,589 parish SACCOs, lending up to UGX 1 million at 6 per cent a year. It says 183,430 of 222,389 enterprise groups are profiled on the programme's information system; the figures are the government's own.

DIGITAL TAX STAMPS

- **URA lauds Manufacturers on DTS success** — Nile Post, 15 September 2026

  Unit stamp prices, 1,680 registered manufacturers and 13 excisable products, eight years into Uganda's DTS.

HEALTH FACILITY ELECTRONIC MEDICAL RECORD SYSTEM

- **Health: Kiryandongo health facilities struggle with EMR system** — New Vision (Uganda), 21 September 2026

  Clinic data capture at every stage lengthens queues; staff cite connectivity, power, too few computers.

ELECTRONIC COURT CASE MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM (ECCMIS)

- **Judiciary Cleans Case Records Ahead of ECCMIS Rollout in Nine Courts** — Uganda Radio Network, 10 October 2026

  Mpigi High Court and eight magistrates' courts reconcile paper files 6-16 October 2026 before going electronic.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC GOVERNMENT PROCUREMENT SYSTEM

- **Musasizi Tasks Accountants on Fiscal Discipline, Accountability** — Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development (Uganda), 3 September 2026

  Finance minister to the ICPAU seminar, 3 Sept 2026: e-government procurement, budget-execution controls, ATMS.

POLICE ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE CHATBOT

- **Uganda: UPF Set to Launch AI Chatbot to Improve Access to Police Services** — Nile Post, syndicated by allAfrica, 3 September 2026

  UPF says the chatbot will supplement, not replace, the 999 emergency line.

FREE PUBLIC ACCESS TO THE ELECTRONIC UGANDA GAZETTE

- **UPPC opens free digital access to the Uganda Gazette** — Uganda Printing and Publishing Corporation (UPPC), 7 October 2026

  Government Printer drops E-Gazette fees; archive digitised to 1902; 80% of products digital by 2028.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SIMPLIFIED COMPUTERISED ACCOUNTING AND REPORTING TOOL (SCART)

- **Govt rolls out digital tool to improve financial accountability in Hoima city** — New Vision (Uganda), 23 September 2026

  SCART web accounting tool at 66 units so far (25 lower local governments, 41 health units and schools).

Technology

AI

SANDI AI SMALLHOLDER CREDIT SCORING

- **Ugandan Startup SANDI AI Wins Shs190M GoGettaz Agripreneur Prize** — Nilepost, 5 September 2026

  US$50,000 top prize at AFS Forum Kigali for AI credit scoring of smallholders who lack collateral.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME, MBARARA UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA KENYA CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S AI SYSTEM FOR FILTERING HARMFUL ONLINE CONTENT

- **Govt Eyes AI Tool to Tackle Rising Nude, Explicit Content on Social Media** — Nilepost, 25 September 2026

  Minister says UCC procuring AI filter for explicit content, must handle local languages; cost, vendor, date undisclosed.

ENTEBBE AIRPORT AI NUMBER-PLATE PARKING SYSTEM

- **Smarter parking at Entebbe: UCAA rolls out AI camera system, digital payments** — Daily Monitor, 9 October 2026

  entervo V3 plate recognition; 2% USSD fee; plate, time and payment logs kept indefinitely, open to police on request.

ICT Industry

ACQUISITION OF A DOMESTIC BANKING-SOFTWARE FIRM

- **CreditChek rachète Algosys pour faciliter le crédit en Afrique de l'Est** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  NIGERIA

  A Nigerian technology company has acquired a Ugandan banking-software firm, bringing every stage of credit - from verifying the borrower's identity to repayment - onto a single platform. The companies say the combination lets African financial institutions assess loan applications faster and lend more readily; no price is disclosed.

Innovation ecosystem

AFRICA-EUROPE DIGITAL INNOVATION BRIDGE 2.0 (AEDIB 2.0)

- **Tender Specifications: Consultancy for Development of a Women in Tech (WiT) Community Platform, and EU-Africa Venture Sourcing (TZA25001-10031)** — Enabel (Belgian Development Agency), 21 September 2026

  TANZANIA SENEGAL

  AEDIB 2.0 (2026-28) in Tanzania, Uganda, Senegal: WiT platform plus 12 EU-Africa ventures; bids close 23 Oct 2026.

NATIONAL E-BOOSTER PROGRAMME, PHASE III

- **UCC seeks partner to accelerate local ICT innovations under third e-Booster phase** — PML Daily, 29 September 2026

  Re-advertised call for one implementing partner for Phase III, FY2026/27; closes 12 Oct 2026; UCUSAF-funded.

Capacity

Literacy

OPERATOR MOBILE-CLASSROOM DIGITAL AND FINANCIAL LITERACY PROGRAMME

- **MTN programme trains 305 Ugandans in digital, financial skills** — Nile Post, 20 September 2026

  305 people graduated in Kampala from the sixth phase of a mobile-classroom digital and financial literacy programme run by the largest mobile operator's foundation, taking the number trained to more than 6,700. The training covers safe internet use, digital productivity and the use of digital financial services.

Training and skills

TECHNICIAN DIPLOMAS IN CYBER SECURITY AND DATA SCIENCE

- **TVET Council approves new technician diplomas in cyber security and data science** — UG Standard, 14 September 2026

  TVET Council approves national technician diplomas in cyber security and data science, pending accreditation.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN THE TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL CURRICULUM

- **Govt introduces AI training in TVET** — New Vision, 15 September 2026

  AI folded into Uganda's 17 new TVET technician diplomas; trainers warn of a knowledge gap and missing labs.

MTN ACE DIGITAL SKILLING PROGRAMME

- **Digital Hubs Must Equip Youth for Jobs, says PS Zawedde** — Nile Post, 16 September 2026

MTN Foundation Uganda and the ICT ministry handed over a second innovation hub at Busitema University, part of a Shs4 billion three-year programme for four university hubs and a refurbished national hub in Kampala. The programme expects to reach more than 20,000 students and community members.

Research institutions

JAPANESE DEVELOPMENT AGENCY RESEARCH COLLABORATION WITH THE NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

- **JICA, Makerere University Explore New Frontiers in AI and Research Collaboration** — Makerere University News, 4 September 2026

  Makerere University and Japan's international cooperation agency explored strengthening academic, research and innovation collaboration between Uganda, Japan and other African countries, with a focus on artificial intelligence, aerospace engineering, materials and remote sensing, food value chains, energy, water and climate change.

Inclusion

Access to services

REFUGEE INTERNET USE BY GENDER

- **Closing the digital divide for refugee women means understanding their full experience of connectivity** — GSMA Mobile for Humanitarian Innovation (Zainab Moallin), 10 September 2026 ETHIOPIA TANZANIA MAURITANIA GLOBAL

  GSMA's own account: refugee women in Ethiopia twice as likely to hold SIMs in others' names; Mbera fieldwork.

- **Digital inclusion for refugee women must go beyond connectivity: GSMA** — Biometric Update, 14 September 2026 ETHIOPIA TANZANIA GLOBAL

  GSMA research finds identity rules for SIM registration push refugee women in Ethiopia and Tanzania to register lines in others' names, limiting control of mobile money and communication. In Uganda about 25% of refugee women use the internet against 50% of men.

SMART VILLAGES PILOT

- **Buhadyo Primary School Smart Classroom Enhancing E-Learning in Butaleja District** — Ministry of ICT and National Guidance, Uganda, 23 September 2026

  Smart Villages pilot with Huawei: solar-powered smart classroom, tower and household power in an unserved district.

Digital divides

OYAM RURAL COMMUNITY BROADBAND NETWORK

- **Free internet access excites traders in Oyam market** — The Observer (Uganda), 14 September 2026

  12-site rural community broadband network in Oyam in technical testing; a vendor's Shs5,000 daily data spend gone.

Data

National statistics

FOURTH PLAN FOR NATIONAL STATISTICAL DEVELOPMENT

> - **UBOS partners with Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola to improve community data** — Uganda Broadcasting Corporation, 6 September 2026
>
>   UBOS MoUs with the Samia Bugwe and Tieng Adhola cultural institutions on births, deaths and community data.

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